

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 935

By Haile

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Anna Armstrong Coile Durham of Gallatin.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the passing of Anna Coile Durham, who will be fondly remembered as a lifelong learner and student of numerous disciplines, a mental health proponent, a skillful Southern hostess, and a devoted wife, mother, and grandmother; and

WHEREAS, a native of Knoxville, Anna Armstrong Coile Durham was the daughter of Grace Anna Armstrong Coile and Eugene Leland Coile; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Coile graduated first in her class from the Collegiate School for Girls in Richmond, Virginia; in an early display of her characteristic determination, she overcame a high fever to deliver her valedictory address; and

WHEREAS, while attending Vanderbilt University, Ms. Coile met a World War II veteran named Walter Durham; both parties had a grandfather who had served in the Tennessee Senate, and their inherited and mutual love of politics became a shared interest upon which they built their budding relationship; and

WHEREAS, upon her graduation from Vanderbilt, Anna Coile married Walter Durham and moved to Gallatin, where she spent most of her adult life; and

WHEREAS, although she was soon busy raising their family, Mrs. Durham continued her educational and intellectual pursuits with vigor; she was an avid reader and a serious student of philosophy and metaphysics; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Durham was an early proponent of healthy living and fed her family according to forward-thinking guidelines endorsed by pioneering nutritionists; and

WHEREAS, she later studied various healing practices at the Estuary in Nashville, thoroughly exploring and sincerely committing herself to the three-tiered model of mind, body, and spirit healing; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Durham demonstrated her passion for mental health care and treatment by co-founding the Sumner County Mental Health Services Center; despite some initial skepticism, the center was enthusiastically welcomed by the community; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Durham served as the center's first board chair and was a decades-long supporter, taking great pride in her role in making mental health care and treatment more accessible; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Durham also served as the unofficial editor and proofreader for her husband, who was a distinguished author of twenty-four books on local history and had served as Tennessee State Historian; and

WHEREAS, she also supported many other civic and historical organizations and was a lifelong member of Gallatin's First United Methodist Church; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Durham entertained often with her own style of elegance, charm, and wit; many of her social gatherings welcomed newcomers to Gallatin or celebrated marriages or babies, but others were devoted to more serious political or historical discussions; and

WHEREAS, Anna Coile Durham is survived by her children, Anna Durham Windrow (Thomas Lanham), Robert "Bob" Coile Durham, James "Jim" Franklin (Lynee) Durham, and Elizabeth Durham Lindsey; her grandchildren, Robert Leland (Dana) Windrow, Samantha Lindsey (Jesus) Tavera, Stanley Doak Lindsey, and Allison Lynee Durham (Lewis Rogers); and six great-grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Anna Coile Durham is deeply mourned by her loving family and her friends and neighbors in Gallatin, and we wish to pay our respects to a gracious lady who lived the examined life of the mind while serving others with her heart; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we celebrate the life of Anna Armstrong Coile Durham, even as we honor her memory and mourn her passing, remembering her life of purpose and commitment to her community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our condolences to Mrs. Durham's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.